



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

JAN 2018

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January

Good Things Happen
is the newsletter of
Minnehaha United Methodist Church,
published each month.

The deadline for February is

January 19

Contributions may be brought to the office
or emailed to:
office@minnehaha.org

Minneapolis, MN 55417

About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011

SUNDAY WORSHIP

- 9:00 am Worship with organ and choir.
- 10:15 am Education and Fellowship.
- 11:00 am Worship with band and vocals.

Infant and toddler care available all morning.



Minnehaha Happenings in January

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
	1 <i>New Year's Day</i> 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon	2 9a Fun & Fitness Group 10:30a Food Shelf 6:30p Toastmasters	3 10a Staff Meeting 1p Minnehaha circle 5p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir 7p Children's Council	4 9a Food Shelf Board 9a Fun & Fit 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 10a World Religions 10:15a Brighter Minds	5 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA	6 <i>Epiphany</i> 10:15 Brighter Minds 5p Childcare night
7 Communion 9a Worship with Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 4p Living Brave 4p Youth & Confirmation Classes 6p Play rehearsal 7p SAA	8 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p Play Rehearsal 6:30p What Do United Methodists Believe?	9 9a Fun & Fit 10:30a Food Shelf 1p Pasta dinner set up 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Church Council	10 Food Shelf Pasta Dinner 5p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir	11 9a Fun & Fit 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a World Religions 1p Communion @ Nokomis Sq 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Play Rehearsal	12 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA 7p Fellowship Hall reserved 7p Taizé 7p fellowship hall reserved	13 8a Nokomis Neighborhood Group 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 6p Scouts - Crew 1
14 9a Worship with Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 3:30p Young Families Dinner 6p Play rehearsal 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	15 <i>Martin Luther King</i> 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p Play Rehearsal 6:30p What Do United Methodists Believe?	16 9a Fun & Fit 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Play Rehearsal 6:30p Toastmasters 6:30p Worship Committee	17 Dinner and Program 5p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir	18 9a Fun & Fit 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a World Religions 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Play Rehearsal	19 Newsletter items due 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA	20 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 1p Ukulele Class
21 9a Worship with Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 1p Annual Meeting 2p Youth Group 6p Play rehearsal 7p SAA	22 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Pack Meeting 6:30p Play Rehearsal 6:30p What Do United Methodists Believe?	23 9a Fun & Fit 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Play Rehearsal 6:30p SPR	24 Dinner and Program 5p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir	25 9a Fun & Fit 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a World Religions 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Play Rehearsal 6:30p Trustees & B+G	26 Winter Retreat 9a Brighter Minds 9a Newsletter Collation 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA	27 Winter Retreat Brighter Minds Recitals (afternoon tbd) 7a MinneHarvest 9:30a Brighter Minds Music
28 Winter Retreat Brighter Minds Recitals (afternoon tbd) 9a Worship with Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 6p Play rehearsal 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	29 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p Cub Scouts 6:30p Play Rehearsal 6:30p What Do United Methodists Believe?	30 9a Fun & Fit 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Play Rehearsal	31 Dinner and Program 5p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir	Notes: <i>The calendar is accurate, to the best of our knowledge, at the time of printing. Dates and details may change at any time. Please visit www.minnehaha.org to view an up-to-date version of the calendar, and please contact Heather before scheduling any meetings or events. If they aren't on the calendar, you are not guaranteed a meeting space.</i>		

Worship in January

We leave the seasons of Advent and Christmas behind, and enter into the season of Epiphany in January. Epiphany always starts with the visit of the Magi, but then it moves from there into "ordinary" stories of the life of Jesus. Just like the period of time between Pentecost and Advent (most of the summer and fall), this is considered Ordinary Time in the liturgical life of the church. The past few years, we have used this "ordinary" time to explore a topic, and this year we will be looking at issues of social justice that the church has spoken out about. We'll look at refugees/immigration, civil rights, human trafficking, poverty, and care for the environment. We also return to our "ordinary" times of worship, moving back to two services again on January 7. See you in worship!

7th	"Social Justice—Immigration"	Matthew 2:13-16
10th	"Social Justice—Civil Rights"	Assorted readings
21st	"Social Justice—Human Trafficking"	Romans 12:9-21
28th	"Social Justice—Poverty"	Luke 3:10-11

Save the Date

Future special events at Minnehaha UMC:

Feb. 10-11 – Annual musical *Rockin' Snow White*

Feb. 14 – Ash Wednesday (Lent begins)

March 3 – Auction

March 11 – Daylight Savings begins
(spring ahead)

March 24 – First annual Talent Show and
Dessert Auction

March 29 – Maundy Thursday

March 30 – Good Friday

April 1 – Easter Sunday



Minnehaha Chili Cook-Off and Game Night

Hosted by Todd and Tracy Gulliver
For MUMC Adults of All Ages

When: Saturday, January 13th from 5-9pm

Where: Becketwood's Windsor Room (4300 W. River Pkwy, Mpls)

Join us for food, fun and conversation at a potluck. Bring your favorite chili, a side dish, and/or a dessert to share. Games and conversation are optional but highly recommended. (Seating at the table for introverts is limited, so reserve your spot with Tracy now!)

Direct questions and RSVP to Tracy Gulliver at tracygulliver@gmail.com



WEDNESDAY
NIGHT
Suppers

STARTING WEDNESDAY, 17th JANUARY

Join us at Minnehaha for supper from 5:30-6:30 in the Fellowship Hall.

Cost for Dinner:
\$5 for those 4 years and older
Free for children under 4
Family Cap: \$20
PURCHASE A PUNCH CARD & RECEIVE FOUR MEALS FREE!

Additionally, this date will be the kick off for 2018 Wednesday Night Programming for kids.

From 6:15-7pm each week, elementary students will meet to prepare for Children's Sunday, preschoolers & kindergartners will have activity time.

RELIEVE EDITORIAL STRESS:

**TURN IN
YOUR ARTICLES
EARLY!**

RE M I N D E R :

**DEADLINE FOR
NEWSLETTER
ARTICLES IS**

January 19

Youth Ministries

Upcoming Events

Jan 7th Confirmation: Classes are from 4:00-5:30pm.

- 6th– 7th Grades are with Lani in the 3rd floor Youth Room working on the newest edition of "Youth News",
- 8th-9th Grades are with Becky in the 3rd floor Choir Room learning about the Holy Trinity.

Jan 14th No evening Confirmation classes – MLK Jr. Weekend

Jan 21st Youth Night: Bakers Square outing -

The youth voted and decided they would like one very laid back youth night where we will all go out to eat and just enjoy some fellowship time together. We will be gathering at the church at 3pm and driving over to Bakers Square in Highland Park, and will be back at 6pm. No set dollar amount as some youth have expressed interest in having dinner, while others would just like some pie, so please just make sure they have enough to cover what they would like to eat.

Jan 26-28 Winter Retreat Weekend! All Ages welcome - See the form on page 9 or the website!

Feb 4th Super Bowl "Subs for Scholarships" Sunday:

Youth will be meeting in the church kitchen at 8:30am to prepare sub sandwiches that will be for sale after both services. Proceeds will go to help youth camps and scholarships, so please stop by the Narthex after worship and pick up the family some sub sandwiches for lunch!

*No evening Confirmation classes – Enjoy the Game!

A Quick look into the future.....

Feb. 11 Youth Giving out Hugs after 1st service

- Youth night: Snack Crates!

Feb. 13 Youth celebrating Fat Tuesday

Feb. 14 Ash Wednesday dinner and service

Feb. 18 President's Day weekend – No Confirmation

Feb. 24 Minneharvest - Youth Volunteering

Feb. 25 Camp Sunday: Youth Bake Sale

- Confirmation: Youth News/Making Good decisions

Mar. 3 Church Auction: Youth serve lunch

Thank you!

Leilani Thompson, *Director of Youth Ministries*



Minnehaha Playgroup

For Children 5 and Under & their Caregivers

Thursdays, from 9-11am

Stop in to play, talk, explore, support, and learn together. Feel free to bring snacks (no peanuts, please) if your child will need them. No RSVP necessary. All are welcome.

hosted by

Minnehaha United Methodist Church

When weather permits, we gather at local parks for playgroup. Otherwise, we meet at Minnehaha UMC, in the Childcare Room. If you'd like to join us on any given week, and want to know where to find us: join the "Minnehaha Playgroup" Facebook Page for weekly updates.

Children's Ministries

At the end of this month, members of Minnehaha will be gathering for our annual Winter Retreat at Lake Koronis Assembly Grounds in Paynesville. The theme this year is "Fill My Cup" and we'll be exploring different ways that we can recharge, renew, and reenergize. Our individual lives can feel quite crazy, & our communal life can feel quite crazy as well. We strive, at Minnehaha, to be a place that offers renewal - that feeds your soul so that you are better able to face whatever it is in store for you. Children need this, too, of course. They need a place that feels safe, a place where they know that they are loved and taken for, where they are free to be themselves and to explore what they might become.



Over this winter at Minnehaha, besides Winter Retreat (the registration form is in this newsletter, sign up today!), we'll be offering a variety of opportunities for children & adults to fill their cups. From time at Sunday School to the start of Wednesday night programming for children: these opportunities to connect with peers, with teachers, and with their faith give children a chance to recharge. The Winter Young Family Dinner and Winter Retreat gives families opportunities to connect with each other and more, giving us all a chance to reenergize. The Child Care Night gives kids a chance to connect with each other, while parents have a chance for a night out.



A new event we're offering this winter is the Minnehaha Family Book Club. While the event itself is not until February 24th, we encourage you to mark your calendars now. For families interested in reading a chapter book, we encourage you to read that as a family before February 24th (maybe start now!). We'll be reading (and then discussion and doing activities about) *The Tale of Despereaux* by Kate DiCamillo. For families who are not quite ready for reading chapter books, simply join us February 24th, we'll be reading a great picture book together: Tomie De Paolo's *The Knight and the Dragon*, and will be doing activities around its themes.

If you have other ideas about how Minnehaha might help you and your family to be renewed, please share them with us - we're always open to new ideas!

With that, I hope you all had a wonderful Christmas. I look forward to a wonderful 2018 together!

Jenia Strom
Director of Children & Family Ministries

Minnehaha Young Families Winter Dinner

Who: Babies & toddlers & their families

When: Sunday, 14th January, 4:30-6pm

Where: Minnehaha Fellowship Hall

Join us for a chance to play, to connect, to be in community with other young families. Minnehaha Children's Council will provide dinner, just come for a relaxing evening together.

Questions? Contact Jenia Strom at
education@minnehaha.org or 612.721.6231

www.minnehaha.org

Highlights from the December 12 Church Council Meeting

TREASURER'S REPORT: The church budget is on track with only one month to go in the fiscal year. Contributions and expenses are in line with projections. We are current with all bills, mortgage payments, apportionment payments and inter-fund loan payments through November 30, 2017. Our Treasurer is "cautiously optimistic" about where we'll be at the end of the year. That's a good thing. (Dennis Feller, Treasurer)



STEWARDSHIP DRIVE UPDATE: Minnehaha UMC's annual stewardship campaign is going well. About two-thirds of the pledge cards have been returned, and right now giving is up about six to seven percent over last year. If you haven't filled out and turned in your pledge card, there's still time. (Becky Sechrist, Pastor)



MUMC BANS GUNS ON CHURCH PREMISES: Trustees is putting up signs that say "Minnehaha United Methodist Church Bans Guns on Church Premises" on the doors of the church. It is church policy that we do not allow guns on church property, and this makes our position clear. (Kim Kanuit, Trustees)

SIMPSON SHELTER ON DECEMBER 28: Minnehaha will serve at Simpson Shelter on December 28. If you're able to help prep the meal or serve, contact Maureen Trepp. (Maureen Trepp, United Methodist Women)

FOOD SHELF SERVES 609 CLIENTS: In November, the Minnehaha Food Shelf served 609 clients—32% children and 26% seniors. In November, 38,000 lbs. of

goods were given away by the Food Shelf and MinneHarvest combined. (Judy Durfey, Food Shelf)

FOOD SHELF PASTA DINNER ON JAN. 10: Mark your calendars for January 10 from 5:00 – 7:00 p.m. for the annual Pasta Dinner to support the Minnehaha Food Shelf. Food will once again be provided by Fat Lorenzo's, and the popular Accordion Band will return to play for the event. (Judy Durfey, Food Shelf)

PARENTS' NIGHT OUT SAT., JAN. 6: The Children's Council will offer its next Child Care/Parents' Night Out on Saturday, January 6. Take time out after the holidays. Relax. Sign-up is on the church website. (Jenia Strom, Children's Ministries; Sarah Emrick, Children's Council)



MAKE TIME FOR THE WINTER RETREAT JAN. 26–28: Every year the people of Minnehaha UMC travel to Lake Koronis Assembly Grounds in Paynesville, MN, for a winter retreat. We gather together for fellowship, relaxation, learning and worship. (And broomball.) The theme this year is: Fill My Cup. Go to the church website to register: www.minnehaha.org. (Jenia Strom, Children's Ministries)

ANNUAL MEETING ON SUN., JAN. 21 AT 1:00 PM: Everyone is both invited and encouraged to come to the Annual Meeting of the Church on January 21 at 1:00 p.m. We'll talk about highlights from 2017, plans for 2018, adopt a budget, approve new committee chairs and more. Plus, there'll be a Values Workshop afterwards where we'll identify the Values that define the church. (Dean Ammerman, Church Council)

NEXT MEETING IS JANUARY 9: The next Church Council meeting will be January 9 at 6:30 p.m. Everyone in the church is invited to attend. Complete minutes of the meeting are available on request. (Dean Ammerman, Church Council)

—submitted by Dean Ammerman, Church Council Chair

Adult Classes

World Religions

A new 6-week class will begin on Thursday, January 4 from 10-11:30. Utilizing a video series, we'll learn about the major religions of the world – Hinduism, Buddhism, Judaism, and Islam, as well as learn a bit more about the differences in Christianity between Protestants, Catholics, and Orthodox. There is no need to prepare anything beforehand, just come to class (room 208 with the large screen television), watch the dvd, and engage in conversation.

What Do United Methodists Believe?

Although theology in the United Methodist Church is not a rigid thing, there are particular beliefs that define who we are. If you'd like to find out more about what United Methodists believe about concepts like heaven, hell, grace, baptism, etc., come on Monday evenings from 6:30-7:30pm. The class starts on January 8 and runs through Feb. 12. Depending on the size of the class and other uses of the building, we'll either be in the chapel on the main floor or up in room 310. Look for a sign at the front entrance letting you know what room we'll be in each evening.

Communion at Nokomis Square

On the second Thursday of the month at 1:00 p.m., there is a brief communion service at Nokomis Square preceded by a discussion of some kind around current events in the world or in the church. In January we will be gathering on January 11.

AUCTION

Saturday, March 3



Coffee & Doughnuts:
10 AM – 12 Noon

Auction Preview:
10 AM

AUCTION STARTS:
11:01 AM

Lunch Served:
12 Noon – 1:30 PM

Note: Delivery available. Starting at \$25.
All prices moved day of sale. Storage fee
for anything left at church past Saturday.

Cabinets, collectibles, housewares, furniture, antiques,
gift certificates, food, crafts, electronics, kids' stuff,
toys, books and who knows what else!

Minnehaha United Methodist Church
3701 East 50th Street | Minneapolis, MN | 612-721-6231 | www.minnehaha.org



*As we start off a 2018 – fresh out of the holiday season –
let's be sure to make time amidst the craziness for time together,
for fun, for calm, for sanity's sake...*

the Minnehaha Children's Council's
**Winter Child Care at Minnehaha
 & Parents' Night Out**

When: Saturday, 6th January from 5-8pm
Where: Child Care Provided at Minnehaha UMC

Cost:
 \$25-1 child
 \$35-2 children
 \$40-3 children

For children up to 10 years of age
proceeds support the children & youth programs

PLEASE RSVP BY December 30th
Online Registration Available – Link at
www.minnehaha.org
or by calling Jenia at 612.721.6231

How to Play Ukulele

*A Workshop by Josh Espinosa,
 Founder of the Approachable Guitar Project*

The ukulele is one of the most accessible musical instruments there is, and it's so affordable that there's practically zero risk in giving it a try. This workshop gets you up and running with the minimal skills you need to start singing and playing songs on the ukulele, and is great for kids (ages 6+) and adults alike.

Plus, you don't even have to own a ukulele to attend the workshop — we'll supply around 10 that attendees can use (or share) during the class.

Contact Josh Espinosa at
josh@approachableguitar.com for more information.

The Minnehaha Players proudly present

The Rockin' Tale of Snow White

Saturday, 10th February at 2pm and 7pm
Sunday, 11th February at 2pm
Tickets: \$10 for adults, \$6 for kids 12 & under,
\$25 family cap

Minnehaha United Methodist Church
3701 E. 50th Street, Minneapolis 55417
www.minnehaha.org

Profits go to support UMW Missions
for Women & Children - Locally & Globally

Food Ministries

MUMC supports **two food ministries**. MinneHarvest is a monthly free food giveaway, and our Food Shelf is a weekly food shelf for residents in our neighborhood, supported by us, Lake Nokomis Lutheran, and St. James Episcopal on the Parkway. Both of these ministries need regular financial support in order for them to continue to provide food to those in need. Please consider making a regular contribution to one or both of these ministries; you can use the handy envelopes provided in the pews, or you can write a check and indicate either MinneHarvest or Food Shelf on the memo line.

United Methodist Women

- UMW Sunday will be on Jan. 21. Watch for and learn about the recipients of our annual Service Award recognition.
- Circle meetings continue to happen for all of our circles and our Wenonah service circle has helped out recently for events.
- Please attend the annual all ages musical, this year "The Rockin' Tale of Snow White" on Sat., Feb. 10 at 2:00 and 7:00 or Sun., Feb. 11 at 2:00. A fun show highlighting several families from our church.
- We will be serving again at Simpson Shelter on Feb. 26.

Time for Renewal

It's easy to get caught up in the daily demands of life. In our busyness, we can lose track of ourselves, and of what God is calling us to be and to do. Take an opportunity to slow down, to rest in silence and music, and to feed your soul. On the second Friday of each month at 7:00 p.m. from October through May, we offer a Taizé service, a time of sanctuary, a time for prayer, a time for community, and a time for silence. As we sing and pray, our hearts are opened so that we may hear God speaking to us, and our souls are fed so that we may be about God's work in the world. Please join us this month on January 12 for a time of renewal.

Annual Meeting

Our Annual Meeting (otherwise known as a Church Conference) will be held on Sunday, January 21, 2018 from 1-3 in the afternoon at the church. In addition to the usual things (like passing the budget and the slate of leaders for next year), we'll also be doing an exercise to help us determine the values we hold important here at Minnehaha UMC. For the values exercise, it will be more effective the more people participate. So, please come on Sunday, January 21, and be part of the conversation.

Thanksgiving Offering

Thank you all for your generosity -- \$537 was donated through our Thanksgiving offering, 10% of which we were able to give to our food ministries.



Minnehaha Young Families' Parent/Child Sunday School

on Sunday, January 21st from 10:15-11:00am
in the Child Care Room, room 204

Babies & toddlers and their families are invited to join us for
a morning of songs, stories, activities, and fellowship.

Questions? Contact Jenia Strom at education@minnehaha.org or 612.721.6231
www.minnehaha.org

Join us for ...



Minnehaha's Winter Retreat



Jan. 26th-28th, 2018
at Lake Koronis
Assembly Grounds

What will we do there?

Broomball
Bonfire
Basketball
Volleyball
Napping
Reading
Long walks in the woods
Movies
Cards
Board Games
Jigsaw Puzzles
Skit Night
Ping Pong
Air Hockey
Ice Skating
Cross-country Sking
Snow shoeing
Programming for adults, youth, & children
Worship on Sunday morning
No cooking; no washing dishes, no housework. Personal hygiene is optional.

Still have questions?

Talk to Joe Schlosser, Jenia Strom,
Leilani Thompson, Paul Minehart, or
Becky Sechrist.

*We look forward
to seeing you there!*

Registration

Name(s) and age(s) of those
attending:

Address: _____

Phone Number: _____

Email: _____

Dietary Restrictions: _____

Carpools will be arranged.

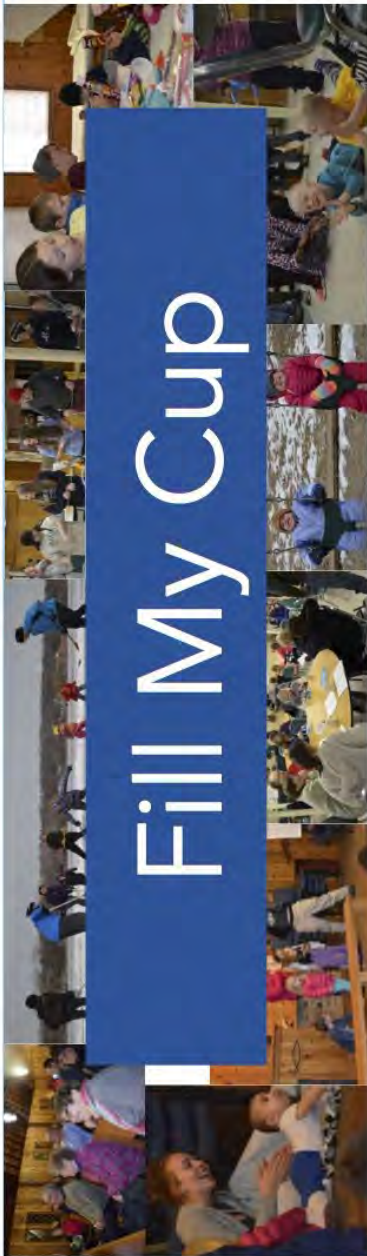
- ☐ I am able and willing to drive, I have room for _____
☐ I need a ride to the retreat.

Pricing information is listed on
the backside of this form.

Please complete it and
submit to the office.

Alternately, you can register
online at:

<https://form.jotform.com/Minnehaha/minnehaha-winter-retreat-2018>



Fill My Cup

Does life seem a little overwhelming sometimes? Do you feel like you are constantly running on empty? Come join our great community for a fun, relaxing winter weekend away, and explore different ways to "fill your cup!" There will be structured time for discussion and exploring new ideas, as well as free time for you to do activities YOU find most fulfilling. What better way to spend the weekend?!

Come back restored-- full of energy and renewed purpose for sharing your gifts with the world.

Each year, people from Minnehaha UMC travel north to Lake Koronis Assembly Grounds in Paynesville, MN. For the

weekend, we leave our busy schedules behind and gather together for fellowship, for relaxation, and for learning and worship.

Your registration fee gives you:

- 2 nights lodging
- 5 meals (breakfast, lunch, and dinner on Saturday, and breakfast and lunch on Sunday)
- 3 hours of childcare
- 24/7 intergenerational opportunities
- Lots of playmates for everyone!

2018 Winter Retreat Pricing

1 Adult Lakeview	\$125
2 Adults Lakeview	\$250
1 Adult Sunrise	\$190
2 Adults Sunrise	\$300
Youth (11-18)	\$95
Children (4-11)	\$80
Infant/Toddler (0-3)	Free

Lakeview: Twin beds, shared bathroom down the hall.

Sunrise: Two full sized beds, private bathroom in the room.

Please look to the left to see what your registration pays for. No refunds for people who leave early and/or eat less than 5 meals. The amount paid by partial attendees not used to cover the cost of this weekend will go into the camp scholarship fund.

Families in need are encouraged to ask for a scholarship (please speak with Jenia Strom, Joe Schlosser or Jason Emrick). If you would be willing to contribute to help others attend winter retreat, please indicate that amount below.

Total Amount Due: _____
Total Amount Paid: _____



Return registration form and check by January 15th to
Minnehaha United Methodist

3701 East 50th Street
 Minneapolis, MN 55417
 Phone: 612/721-6231
www.minnehaha.org



My Inheritance



I had Thanksgiving dinner with my dad this year – for only the second time in my adult life (it’s a long story – if you really want to know, you can ask me about it). He was sitting to my right, and about half way through the meal, he looked down at my plate, then up at my face and said, “do you realize that you have your mother’s hands?” Well, yes, I had realized that. I remember my first year out of college, holding my hands out in front of my face and realizing that they were my mother’s hands. Of course, I’d also just walked through my apartment turning off lights from room to room as I called out, “Hey, if no one is using the light in here, then turn it off!” I had my father’s fanatical tendencies for conservation and my mother’s hands. Over the years, my brother and I have often compared notes about just what we inherited from our parents. Some of it has been physical (my brother’s back is worse than mine, but I got the genetically bad knees), and some of it ideological (we both find it hard to “relax” before our chores are done, even though we were quite capable to doing that as children). As my brother and I have had to make some joint decisions over the years, I am increasingly grateful that through a combination of our own choices and childhood rules, we have a similar set of values. This is not true for every family, and I am well aware of this as I watch families make difficult decisions fairly regularly. Even though my brother and I are very different people, it turns out that we have a fairly large pool of values in common, and those common values help us to do difficult things without arguing with each other (much) in the process. We agree on what needs to be done, even if we don’t always agree entirely on the best way to do it.

This seems to be a key in any group that has to make decisions together. Even if we disagree about implementation, having a common set of values lays the important groundwork on what is important to do. As a congregation, we often make important decisions together. Decisions that might range from the mundane (should we fix the dishwasher?) to the complicated (can we support the Dauds?). Each of these decisions gets a little more clear when we are able to identify our values and the relationship between them and the thing we are discussing.

We will have an opportunity to do some work clarifying our values at our Annual Meeting this year (Sunday, Jan. 21 from 1:00 – 3:00 p.m.). The more of you who participate, the more accurate the process will be. It’ll help us clarify what we have inherited from previous generations of our congregation as well as what we bring to the mix in the world today. Whether or not you have your mother’s hands, and whether or not you like that, join the conversation as we identify the values that make us Minnehaha United Methodist Church in 2018.

In joy,

Becky



3701 East 50th Street
Minneapolis, MN 55417

Address Service Requested

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1/18



Food Shelf Fundraiser



Pasta Dinner

donated by Fat Lorenzo's

Plus Door Prizes, Accordion Band & More!

Wednesday, January 10th

5:00 – 7:00 PM

Adults: \$10 | Ages 12 & Under: Free

MINNEHAHA UNITED METHODIST CHURCH
3701 East 50th St., Mpls • www.minnehaha.org/foodshelf.html



Memorial Service for Jo Fontaine Dec. 30

Jolyn Fontaine, Director of Christian Ed at Minnehaha from 1982-2011, died from pancreatic cancer on December 19.

A memorial service for Jo will be held at Minnehaha on Saturday, Dec. 30 at 10:00 with a breakfast of scones following (all per Jo's wishes).